

Basics of Communication

1.1 Introduction

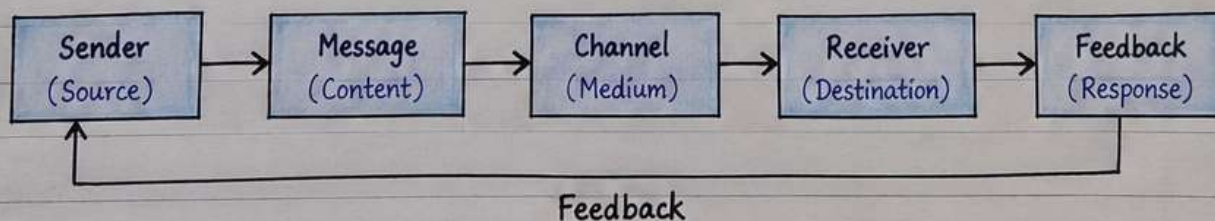
Communication is an essential part of human life. It is the process through which we share our ideas, thoughts, information, feelings and opinions with others. It helps in understanding, building relationships and achieving common goals. Without communication, it would be difficult to live and work together in a society. Communication can be done in various forms such as speaking, writing, listening, gestures or using modern technology like phone, email and internet.

1.2 Definition of Communication

Communication can be defined as the process of exchanging information, ideas, thoughts or feelings between two or more persons with the purpose of creating a common understanding. It involves a sender who transmits the message, a medium or channel through which the message is sent and a receiver who gets the message. According to Oxford Dictionary, communication means "the act of giving, receiving or sharing information". In simple words, communication is a two-way process of sharing and understanding.

1.3 Process of Communication

Communication is not just sending a message, it is a complete process that involves several steps. The process of communication ensures that the message is properly understood by the receiver. It includes the following elements :



1. Sender : The person who has the idea or information and sends the message.
2. Message : The information, ideas or feelings that are to be communicated.
3. Channel : The medium through which the message is transmitted (e.g. speech, letter, phone).
4. Receiver : The person who receives the message.
5. Feedback : The response given by the receiver, which shows whether the message has been understood or not.

Types of Communication - Formal and Informal

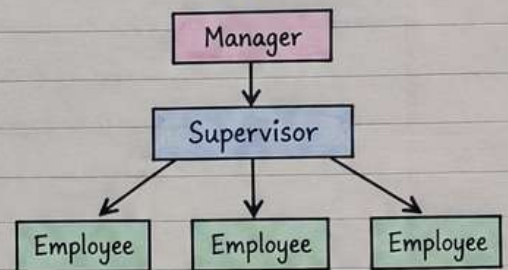
Communication can be classified into different types on the basis of purpose, form, direction and the relationship among people. The two important types are Formal Communication and Informal Communication. Both are necessary in an organisation and serve different purposes.

1. Formal Communication

Formal communication is the official communication that takes place within a specified organisational structure. It follows the rules, policies and hierarchy of the organisation. The message is transmitted through authorized channels and is usually in written form, such as notices, reports, memos, letters and emails. It is goal-oriented and job-related. Formal communication ensures discipline, coordination and proper flow of information in an organisation.

Examples :

- Instructions from a manager to employees.
- Official letters and circulars.
- Reports, meetings and presentations.
- Emails related to work.



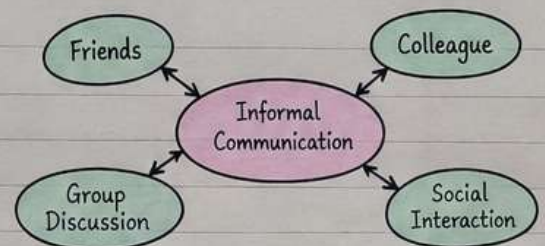
Formal Communication Flow

2. Informal Communication

Informal communication is the unofficial and spontaneous communication that takes place outside the formal structure of an organisation. It arises naturally through personal and social interactions among members. It does not follow any fixed rules or channel. It is usually in oral form, such as casual talks, discussions, gossip or friendly meetings. Informal communication helps in building good relationships, boosting morale and satisfying social needs.

Examples :

- Casual conversation with colleagues.
- Discussion during tea break.
- Sharing information through friends.
- Social media chats among team members.



3. Difference between Formal and Informal Communication

S.No.	Basis	Formal Communication	Informal Communication
1.	Meaning	Official and planned communication.	Unofficial and spontaneous communication.
2.	Channel	Follows organisational hierarchy.	No fixed channel.
3.	Form	Usually written.	Usually oral.
4.	Purpose	Job-related and goal-oriented.	Social and personal.
5.	Relationship	Maintains discipline and coordination.	Builds friendly relations.
6.	Example	Notices, reports, official emails.	Casual talks, gossip, group chats.

Types of Communication - Oral and Written

On the basis of mode of expression, communication can be classified into Oral Communication and Written Communication. Both are widely used in personal, social and professional life. The choice between the two depends on the purpose, situation and the nature of the message.

1. Oral Communication

Oral communication is the process of exchanging information through spoken words. It is the most common and natural form of communication. It includes face-to-face conversations, telephonic calls, speeches, interviews, discussions, meetings and video calls. In oral communication, the message is delivered verbally and the receiver can give immediate feedback. It helps in quick decision making and is useful when personal interaction is possible.

Examples of Oral Communication

- Face-to-face conversation
- Telephone calls
- Speeches and lectures
- Group discussions
- Meetings and interviews
- Video conferencing
- Casual talks



Oral Communication
(Face-to-Face)

2. Written Communication

Written communication is the process of exchanging information through written symbols or text. It includes letters, emails, reports, notices, manuals, messages, etc. It is a more formal and permanent form of communication. Written communication is useful when detailed information is to be shared and when a record is required for future reference. It is widely used in business, education and government organisations.

Examples of Written Communication

- Letters (formal and informal)
- Emails
- Reports
- Notices and circulars
- Text messages
- Manuals and documentation
- Social media posts (written form)



Written Communication
(Letter / Email)

3. Difference between Oral and Written Communication

S.No.	Basis	Oral Communication	Written Communication
1.	Meaning	Exchange of information through spoken words.	Exchange of information through written symbols or text.
2.	Mode	Verbal (speaking and listening).	Written (reading and writing).
3.	Feedback	Immediate feedback possible.	Delayed feedback.
4.	Record	No permanent record.	Provides permanent record.
5.	Formality	Usually informal.	Usually formal.
6.	Suitability	Useful for quick communication.	Useful for detailed information.
7.	Example	Conversation, phone call, speech.	Letter, email, report, notice.

Types of Communication – Verbal and Non-Verbal

Communication can also be classified on the basis of the use of words and body language. In this context, there are two important types : **Verbal Communication** and **Non-Verbal Communication**. Both types work together to make the message more effective and meaningful.

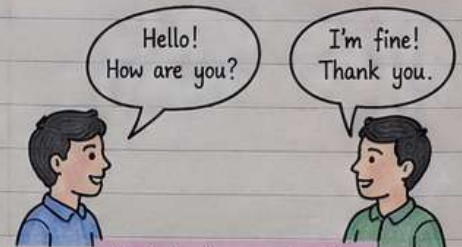
1. Verbal Communication

Verbal communication is the process of exchanging information through words. It includes both spoken and written form of communication. It is the most common and direct way to express ideas, thoughts and feelings. Verbal communication can take place face-to-face, over the telephone, in meetings, through speeches or in written form like letters and emails.

The main advantage of verbal communication is that it allows for clear expression and immediate feedback, especially in oral form. However, the effectiveness of verbal communication depends on the choice of words, tone, language and the listener's understanding.

Examples of Verbal Communication

- Face-to-face conversation
- Telephone calls
- Speeches and lectures
- Meetings and discussions
- Written messages (letters, emails)
- Video conferencing
- Instructions and announcements



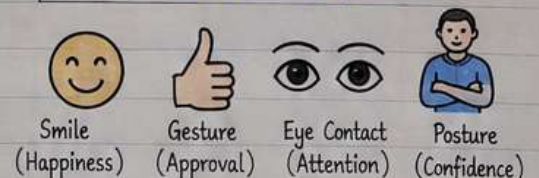
Verbal Communication
(Using Words)

2. Non-Verbal Communication

Non-verbal communication is the process of conveying messages without using words. It includes body language, facial expressions, gestures, posture, eye contact, tone of voice and even silence. Non-verbal communication often supports, complements or sometimes even contradicts verbal messages. It plays an important role in showing emotions and attitudes. For example, a smile can show happiness, a frown can show disapproval, and folded arms may indicate defensiveness. Non-verbal communication is universal and can be understood across different languages and cultures, but its meaning may vary in different contexts.

Examples of Non-Verbal Communication

- Facial expressions (smile, frown)
- Gestures (thumbs up, hand movement)
- Body posture (sitting, standing)
- Eye contact
- Tone of voice (loud, soft)
- Physical appearance (dress, grooming)
- Silence (no response)
- Proxemics (personal space)



3. Difference between Verbal and Non-Verbal Communication

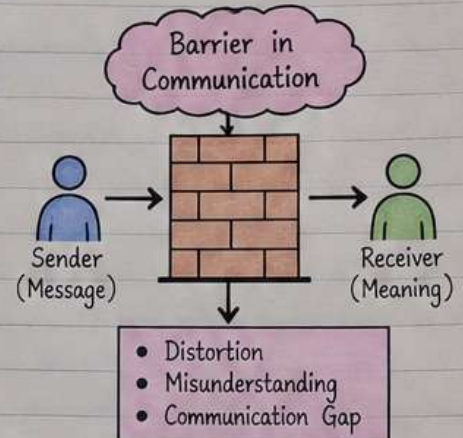
S.No.	Basis	Verbal Communication	Non-Verbal Communication
1.	Meaning	Uses words (spoken or written).	Uses gestures, expressions, etc.
2.	Form	Oral or written.	Visual and behavioural.
3.	Examples	Conversation, speeches, emails.	Facial expressions, gestures, posture.
4.	Feedback	Usually immediate (in oral form).	Often instant and automatic.
5.	Universality	Depends on language.	Generally universal.
6.	Control	Can be planned and controlled.	Often natural and less controlled.
7.	Role	Conveys the actual message.	Supports and enhances the message.

Communication Barriers and How to Overcome Them

Communication is essential for sharing ideas and information, but it is not always smooth. Various barriers can hinder the effective exchange of messages and lead to misunderstanding, confusion and conflict. Understanding these barriers and finding ways to overcome them is important for successful communication in personal, social and professional life.

1. Meaning of Communication Barriers

Communication barriers are the obstacles or difficulties that block, distort or interfere with the transmission and understanding of a message between the sender and the receiver. These barriers can occur at any stage of the communication process and can reduce the effectiveness of communication. As a result, the intended message may not be received correctly, which can lead to errors, dissatisfaction and conflicts.



2. Types of Communication Barriers

Communication barriers can be classified into the following types :

S.No.	Type of Barrier	Explanation	Examples
1.	Physical Barriers	Environmental factors that hinder communication.	Noise, distance, poor lighting, network problems.
2.	Psychological Barriers	Mental state and emotions that affect understanding.	Stress, anger, fear, lack of interest.
3.	Language Barriers	Differences in language or complex words.	Use of technical jargon, different language, poor vocabulary.
4.	Cultural Barriers	Differences in values, beliefs and social norms.	Different traditions, customs, body language.
5.	Organisational Barriers	Barriers within the organisation structure and system.	Rigid hierarchy, lack of proper channels, rules and policies.
6.	Personal Barriers	Individual differences that affect communication.	Lack of confidence, preconceived ideas, ego, poor listening skills.
7.	Technological Barriers	Problems due to communication devices or tools.	Poor internet, technical faults, incompatible software.

3. How to Overcome Communication Barriers

To ensure effective communication, the following measures can be taken :

- Use clear and simple language.
- Be an active listener.
- Reduce noise and other physical disturbances.
- Be open-minded and avoid preconceived notions.
- Use appropriate communication channels.
- Develop cultural awareness and show respect for differences.
- Provide feedback to confirm understanding.
- Use technology effectively and ensure proper tools.
- Build trust and maintain a positive attitude.

Result

- ✓ Better understanding
- ✓ Fewer misunderstandings
- ✓ Stronger relationships
- ✓ Effective teamwork
- ✓ Successful communication

Barriers to Communication

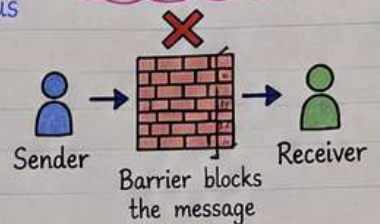
"The single biggest problem in communication is the illusion - that it has taken place."

- George Bernard Shaw

1.1 Meaning of Barriers to Communication

Barriers to communication are the factors or obstacles that hinder the smooth flow of information between the sender and the receiver. These barriers can distort the message, create misunderstanding or prevent the message from reaching its intended goal. Communication may fail completely or partially due to various reasons such as language differences, psychological conditions, physical distance, cultural variations or technical problems. It is important to identify these barriers so that effective communication can be established in personal, professional and social life.

"Good Communication removes barriers and builds better relationships."



1.2 Types of Barriers to Communication

(A) Physical Barriers

Physical barriers are related to the environment or external conditions that prevent effective communication. Examples include noise, distance, poor internet connection, uncomfortable seating, closed doors, etc.

Example : Loud noise in a classroom can make it difficult to hear the speaker clearly.

Examples :

- Noise
- Distance
- Poor infrastructure
- Distractions
- Time constraints

(B) Language Barriers

Language barriers occur when the sender and receiver do not share the same language or have different levels of understanding. Complex words, technical terms and regional languages can also create problems in communication.

Example : A person who does not understand English may find it difficult to follow a lecture delivered in English.

Examples :

- Different language
- Use of difficult words
- Technical jargon
- Different accents
- Poor grammar

(C) Psychological Barriers

Psychological barriers arise due to emotions, attitudes, beliefs and mental state of the individuals. Fear, stress, lack of confidence, prejudice or negative thinking can affect how a message is sent or received.

Example : A person who is angry may misinterpret a simple message as criticism.

Examples :

- Fear and anxiety
- Stress
- Negative attitude
- Lack of confidence
- Prejudice

(D) Cultural Barriers

Cultural barriers occur due to differences in customs, values, traditions and social norms. What is acceptable in one culture may be offensive in another. These differences can lead to misunderstanding and conflict.

Example : A hand gesture that is polite in one country may be considered rude in another.

Examples :

- Different customs
- Different values
- Social norms
- Religious beliefs
- Varied traditions

"Identify the barriers, understand the reason and remove them - for effective communication."

Reading Skill

"Reading is to the mind what exercise is to the body."

- Joseph Addison

2.1 Introduction

Reading is one of the most important language skills. It helps us to gain knowledge, develop our thinking ability and understand the world around us. It is not just about reading words, but about understanding the meaning, analysing the ideas and relating them to real life. Good reading skills improve vocabulary, concentration, imagination and decision-making ability. In academic as well as professional life, reading is essential because it provides us with new information, different perspectives and solutions to problems. With regular practice, we can become better readers and use the information in a meaningful way.

2.2 What is an Unseen Passage ?

An unseen passage is a short piece of writing (prose or poetry) that is not given in the textbook. It is called 'unseen' because the reader has not seen it before. The passage is followed by questions to test the reader's comprehension, vocabulary and grammar. These questions may include one-word substitution, prefixes, suffixes, synonyms, antonyms, true/false, multiple choice questions and short or long answers. The main purpose of an unseen passage is to check how well the reader can understand, interpret and analyse the given text.

Features of an Unseen Passage :

- It is a short and self-contained text.
- It may be factual, descriptive, narrative or argumentative.
- It is not given in the textbook.
- It is followed by comprehension questions.
- It tests vocabulary, grammar and understanding.
- It helps in improving reading and analytical skills.



Good Readers
Make a
Better
Tomorrow

"The more you read, the more things you know.
The more you learn, the more places you'll go."

- Dr. Seuss

2.3 Unseen Passage for Comprehension

Passage - 1

The Value of Trees

Trees are one of the greatest gifts of nature. They not only make our environment clean and green but also provide us with many essentials for life. Trees absorb carbon dioxide and release oxygen, which helps in maintaining a healthy atmosphere. They also prevent soil erosion, provide shelter for birds and animals and maintain the ecological balance. In addition, trees give us fruits, wood, medicines and shade. Despite their importance, trees are being cut down at an alarming rate due to urbanisation and industrialisation. If we do not take steps to protect them, future generations may face severe consequences such as climate change, loss of biodiversity and shortage of natural resources. It is the responsibility of every individual to plant more trees and contribute towards a greener and healthier planet.



"Plant a tree today for a better tomorrow."

A. One-word Substitution (from the passage)

1. Things that are necessary for life → _____
2. To keep something in proper balance → _____
3. The gradual increase of towns and cities → _____
4. Extremely serious or worrying → _____
5. The natural home of a living organism → _____

Remember :

- Read the passage carefully.
- Look for exact words in the passage.
- The one-word should match the meaning given in the question.

B. Prefixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the prefix 'un-' → _____
2. Find a word with the prefix 're-' → _____
3. Find a word with the prefix 'in-' or 'im-' → _____

Common Prefixes :

un- (not)	re- (again)
in-/im- (not)	dis- (opposite)
pre- (before)	non- (not)

C. Suffixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the suffix '-tion' → _____
2. Find a word with the suffix '-ness' → _____
3. Find a word with the suffix '-ful' or '-less' → _____

Common Suffixes :

-tion (action)	-ness (state)
-ful (full of)	-less (without)
-ment (result)	-ing (process)

D. Synonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word similar in meaning to 'serious' → _____
2. Find a word similar in meaning to 'protect' → _____
3. Find a word similar in meaning to 'shortage' → _____

Synonyms help to :

- Improve vocabulary
- Understand the text better
- Express the same idea in different words

E. Antonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'harmful' → _____
2. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'increase' → _____
3. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'natural' → _____

Antonyms help to :

- Understand contrast in meaning
- Improve word power

"A Greener Tomorrow depends on what we do Today."

2.3 Unseen Passage for Comprehension

Practice Passage - 1

Passage : The Power of Technology

Technology has become an integral part of our daily lives. It has changed the way we communicate, learn, work and even think. With the help of the internet and mobile devices, we can connect with people across the world within seconds. Online education has made learning more accessible, and digital platforms have created new opportunities for business and employment. However, excessive use of technology can also have negative effects. It may lead to a sedentary lifestyle, reduce face-to-face interaction and cause distractions. Therefore, it is important to use technology wisely and in a balanced way so that we can enjoy its benefits without harming our physical and mental health.



"Use Technology as a Tool, Not a Distraction."

A. One-word Substitution (from the passage)

1. A device that can be carried easily → _____
2. Able to be reached or obtained easily → _____
3. Not moving much → _____
4. Something that prevents you from giving full attention → _____
5. Using something in a sensible and careful way → _____

Key Words from Passage :

- integral
- communicate
- accessible
- opportunities
- excessive
- distractions
- balanced
- benefits

B. Prefixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the prefix 'in-' → _____
2. Find a word with the prefix 'dis-' → _____
3. Find a word with the prefix 'ex-' → _____

Common Prefixes :

- in- (not)
- dis- (opposite)
- re- (again)
- un- (not)
- pre- (before)
- over- (more than)

C. Suffixes (find from the passage)

1. Find a word with the suffix '-tion' → _____
2. Find a word with the suffix '-ment' → _____
3. Find a word with the suffix '-ly' → _____

Common Suffixes :

- -tion (action)
- -ment (result)
- -ly (in a manner)
- -ful (full of)
- -less (without)
- -ness (state)

D. Synonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word similar in meaning to 'important' → _____
2. Find a word similar in meaning to 'quick' → _____
3. Find a word similar in meaning to 'advantages' → _____

E. Antonyms (from the passage)

1. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'positive' → _____
2. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'increase' → _____
3. Find a word opposite in meaning to 'accessible' → _____

Reading is not just about words, but about understanding the world around you.

Picture Composition

"A picture is worth a thousand words."

- Fred R. Barnard

3.1 Meaning of Picture Composition

Picture composition is a form of writing in which we describe a given picture in the form of a meaningful paragraph or short story. It tests our power of observation, imagination and expression. A picture may show people, places, activities, objects or a situation. We have to carefully observe the details, understand the main idea and then write a coherent and interesting description. The composition should be simple, relevant and in a logical order. It helps in developing our writing skills, creative thinking and the ability to present ideas clearly.

Key Point :

- Observe carefully
- Identify the main idea
- Write in simple language
- Maintain logical order
- Give a suitable title

3.2 Steps to Write a Picture Composition

1. **Observe the picture** - Look at the picture carefully and note down all the important details (people, place, activities, objects, expressions, etc.).
2. **Identify the main idea** - Think about what the picture is trying to convey.
3. **Make points** - Jot down key points in short form (who, what, where, when, why, how).
4. **Arrange in a logical order** - Start with an introduction, then describe the main events or details, and end with a suitable conclusion.
5. **Use simple and correct language** - Write in clear, grammatically correct sentences. Avoid very difficult words.
6. **Give a suitable title** - A good title makes your composition more attractive.
7. **Check and revise** - Read your composition to correct spelling, grammar and coherence.

Example Picture



"Small efforts make a big difference.
Keep our surroundings clean."

3.3 Useful Vocabulary for Picture Composition

- | | |
|--|---|
| ● <u>environment</u> - surrounding conditions | ● <u>pollution</u> - harmful substances in air, water or land |
| ● <u>litter</u> - waste material lying on ground | ● <u>recycle</u> - to use again |
| ● <u>cooperation</u> - working together | ● <u>conservation</u> - protection from waste or damage |
| ● <u>awareness</u> - knowledge or understanding | ● <u>volunteer</u> - a person who works without payment |
| ● <u>hygiene</u> - cleanliness | ● <u>neat and tidy</u> - clean and well arranged |
| ● <u>responsibility</u> - duty to do something | ● <u>initiative</u> - a new plan or effort |
| ● <u>community</u> - a group of people living together | ● <u>healthy</u> - in good physical and mental condition |

"Good writing is clear thinking made visible."

- Bill Wheeler

3.4 Writing a Paragraph

Meaning

A paragraph is a short piece of writing on a single topic. It consists of a group of related sentences that develop a main idea. A good paragraph is clear, well-organized and focused. It helps the reader to understand the writer's thoughts easily. Paragraph writing is an important skill as it is used in essays, letters, reports and other forms of communication. A well-written paragraph should have a topic sentence, supporting details and a concluding sentence.

"Good paragraphs turn ideas into impact."

Structure of a Paragraph

1. **Topic Sentence** - Introduces the main idea of the paragraph.
2. **Supporting Sentences** - Provide details, examples or explanations.
3. **Concluding Sentence** - Summarizes the main idea or gives a final thought.

Paragraph Structure

Topic Sentence
(Introduction)

Supporting Sentences
(Details/Examples)

Concluding Sentence
(Summary)

Important Points to Remember

1. Always stick to one main idea.
2. Keep your sentences simple and clear.
3. Use appropriate linking words (such as, however, therefore, in addition).
4. Maintain a logical flow of ideas.
5. Avoid repetition and unnecessary details.
6. Check for correct grammar, spelling and punctuation.

"A well-written paragraph is a bridge between thoughts and understanding."

Example Paragraph

Topic : Importance of Trees

Trees are an essential part of our life. They give us clean air, shade, fruits and many other resources. Trees help in maintaining the ecological balance by absorbing carbon dioxide and releasing oxygen. They also provide shelter for birds and animals. Moreover, trees prevent soil erosion and keep the environment cool and green. Therefore, we must plant more trees and protect them for a better and healthier future.



Common Topics for Paragraph Writing

- | | |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| • Importance of Education | • Value of Time |
| • My Best Friend | • Role of Technology in Our Life |
| • A Visit to a Hill Station | • A Memorable Day |
| • Pollution and its Effects | • Healthy Lifestyle |

Remember :

- Plan before you write.
- Be clear and concise.
- Use your own words.
- Give a suitable title.
- Keep it within the word limit (usually 100-150 words).

3.5 Notice Writing

Meaning

A notice is a short and formal written communication used to give information to a large number of people. It is usually displayed on a notice board in schools, colleges, offices or public places. A notice is written in a clear, concise and simple language so that it can be easily understood by everyone. It may be issued by an authority, an organization or a group of people. The main purpose of a notice is to inform, make an announcement, give instructions or invite participation in a particular event or activity.



"A good notice communicates more in fewer words."

Format of a Notice

1. Name of the issuing authority (at the top centre)
2. The word "NOTICE" (in bold/UPPRACE and centred)
3. Date (on the left side)
4. Subject / Title (in brief and clear)
5. Main content (information in short points or sentences)
6. Signature / Name and designation (at the bottom left)

Key Points to Remember :

- Keep it short and to the point
- Use simple and formal language
- Mention all essential details (date, time, venue, etc.)
- Use a suitable title
- Avoid unnecessary details
- Check for spelling and grammar

Example Notice

ABC Public School, Kanpur

NOTICE

Date : 20 August 2025

Inter-House Essay Writing Competition

All the students are informed that an Inter-House Essay Writing Competition will be held on 28 August 2025 in the school library at 11:00 a.m. Interested students can give their names to their respective house teachers latest by 25 August 2025. The topic for the competition is "Role of Youth in Building a Better India".

Rohan Sharma
Head Boy

Common Topics for Notice Writing :

- School events and competitions
- Meetings and seminars
- Change in timetable
- Holiday announcements
- Lost and found items
- Awareness programmes
- Inviting participation
- Important instructions



A notice creates awareness and brings people together.

"Write a notice that informs, not confuses."

Unit - 4 : Curriculum Vitae and Resume

4.1 Curriculum Vitae and Resume : Overview

Meaning

A Curriculum Vitae (CV) and a Resume are important documents used while applying for a job, internship or higher studies. They provide a summary of our personal details, educational qualifications, skills, achievements and work experience. These documents help the employer to understand our background and judge whether we are suitable for the position or not. A well-written CV or Resume creates a good first impression and increases the chance of getting an interview. Both should be clear, concise, well-organized and free from errors.

Curriculum Vitae (CV)

Curriculum Vitae is a detailed document that provides a complete overview of a person's life, including education, work experience, skills, achievements, publications, projects and other relevant information. It is usually longer than a resume and is commonly used for academic, research or professional positions, especially in higher education.

Resume

A Resume is a brief and focused document that highlights the most relevant information about a person's education, skills, work experience and achievements. It is usually one to two pages long and is used mainly for job applications in the corporate sector. A resume is tailored to a specific job, so that the most important and relevant details are presented to the employer in a clear and attractive manner.

Key Differences between CV and Resume

Basis	Curriculum Vitae (CV)	Resume
Length	Detailed and longer	Short and concise
Purpose	Used for academic/research positions	Used for job applications
Content	Complete information	Only relevant information
Focus	Overall career history	Specific to the job
Format	Can be multiple pages	Usually 1-2 pages

Purpose :

- Show your profile
- Highlight your skills
- Create a positive impression
- Helps in career growth

"A good CV opens doors to new opportunities."

CURRICULUM VITAE



Name : _____
 Education : _____
 Experience : _____
 Skills : _____
 Achievements : _____

RESUME



Name : _____
 Contact : _____
 Education : _____
 Skills : _____
 Experience : _____

Points to Remember :

- Use a clean and professional format.
- Keep the information accurate.
- Highlight your strengths and achievements.
- Avoid unnecessary or irrelevant details.
- Use proper grammar and simple language.
- Customize your resume for each job.
- Always proofread before submitting.

"Your CV is your story, make it worth reading."

4.2 Types of CV

There are different types of CV, each designed for a specific purpose and career stage. The type of CV you choose depends on your experience, skills, education and the job you are applying for. A well-chosen CV helps you present your strengths in the best possible way and increases your chances of getting selected.

"Choose the right type, Show your best self."

Main Types of CV

1. **Chronological CV** - This is the most common type of CV. It lists your education, work experience and achievements in reverse chronological order (latest first). It is suitable for candidates with a stable work history.
2. **Functional CV** - This type of CV focuses on your skills, abilities and achievements rather than your work history. It is useful for freshers or those with gaps in their careers.
3. **Combination (Hybrid) CV** - It combines both chronological and functional formats. It highlights your skills as well as your work experience. It is suitable for experienced professionals.
4. **Targeted CV** - This CV is customized for a specific job or industry. It includes relevant skills and experience that match the job requirements.
5. **Academic CV** - Used mainly for academic, research or teaching positions. It includes detailed information about education, research work, publications, seminars and academic achievements.

Quick Comparison

- Chronological → Work history first
- Functional → Skills based
- Combination → Skills + Experience
- Targeted → For a specific job
- Academic → For academic and research field



Different CVs for Different Goals."

4.3 Covering Letter

Meaning

A covering letter (also called a cover letter) is a formal letter sent along with your CV or resume when applying for a job. Its main purpose is to introduce yourself, explain why you are interested in the position and highlight your relevant skills and experience. It gives you an opportunity to make a positive first impression and persuade the employer to read your CV.

Key Points :

- Keep it short (1 page)
- Use formal language
- Mention the job title
- Show enthusiasm
- Highlight key skills
- End with a polite closing

Format of a Covering Letter

1. Sender's Address (Your address)
2. Date
3. Receiver's Address (Employer's name, designation, company)
4. Subject (e.g. Application for the post of _____)
5. Salutation (Dear Sir/Madam)
6. Introduction (mention the position and source)
7. Body (highlight your skills, experience and suitability)
8. Closing (express gratitude and request for an interview)
9. Complimentary Close (Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely)
10. Signature and Name

Sample Covering Letter

Rohit Sharma
123, Green Park
Kanpur - 208001
25 August 2025
The Hiring Manager
XYZ Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Kanpur

Subject : Application for the Post of Web Developer

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to apply for the position of Web Developer as advertised on your company website. I have completed my PGDCA and have good knowledge of HTML, CSS, JavaScript and other web technologies. I am eager to contribute my skills to your organization and learn new things.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity for an interview.

Yours sincerely,
(Rohit Sharma)

4.4 Resume

Meaning

A resume is a short, well-organized document that provides a summary of your education, skills, work experience, achievements and other relevant information. It is usually one or two pages long and is used while applying for a job. A good resume helps you create a positive first impression and increases your chances of getting selected for an interview. It should be clear, concise, error-free and tailored to the specific job you are applying for.

"A great resume doesn't just list your experience, it shows your potential."

Key Point :

- Keep it short
- Be honest
- Highlight achievements
- Use clear format
- Tailor it for each job

Importance of a Resume

- **Creates first impression** - Your resume is the first thing an employer sees.
- **Showcases your skills** - Highlights your key skills and strengths.
- **Helps in shortlisting** - A well-written resume increases your chances of getting an interview.
- **Professional growth** - Helps you present your career goals clearly.
- **Useful for multiple opportunities** - Can be used for job, internship or higher studies.



Right Resume
Brighter
Future !

Types of Resume

1. **Chronological Resume** - This is the most common type. It lists your work experience in reverse chronological order (latest first). It is suitable for candidates with a strong and consistent work history.
2. **Functional Resume** - This type focuses on your skills and abilities rather than work history. It is useful for freshers, career changers or those with gaps in their employment.
3. **Combination (Hybrid) Resume** - It combines both chronological and functional formats. It highlights your skills as well as work experience.
4. **Targeted Resume** - This resume is customized for a specific job or industry. It focuses on the most relevant skills and experiences.
5. **Academic Resume** - Used mainly for academic, research or teaching positions. It includes detailed information about education, research work, publications, seminars and academic achievements.

Types of Resume (Visual)

Chronological
Resume

Functional
Resume

Combination
Resume

Targeted
Resume

Academic
Resume

"Different goals
Different resumes
Same success !"

Tips for Writing an Effective Resume

- Keep it short and simple (1-2 pages).
- Use a clean and professional format.
- Include only relevant information.
- Highlight your key skills and achievements.
- Use action verbs (e.g., developed, managed, created).
- Avoid grammatical errors and spelling mistakes.
- Customize your resume for each job application.
- Use clear headings and bullet points.

Common Sections in a Resume

1. Personal Information (Name, Contact, Address)
2. Career Objective
3. Educational Qualifications
4. Work Experience (if any)
5. Skills
6. Achievements / Certifications
7. Projects (if any)
8. Hobbies / Interests (optional)
9. References (optional)

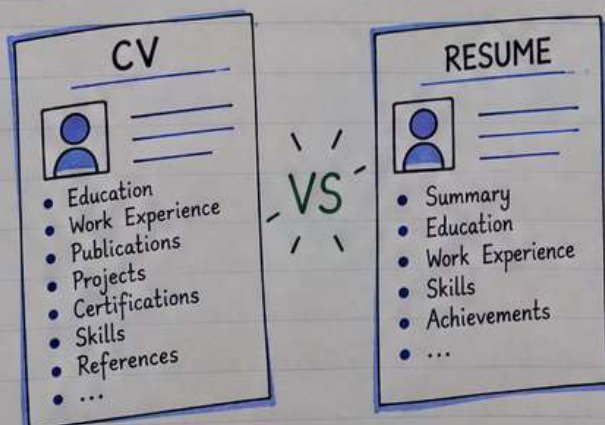
4.5 Difference between CV and Resume

Introduction

Both Curriculum Vitae (CV) and Resume are important documents used while applying for a job, internship or higher studies. They provide information about your education, skills, work experience and achievements. Although the terms CV and Resume are often used interchangeably, there are significant differences between them in terms of length, purpose, content and usage. Understanding these differences helps you choose the right document for the right opportunity.

"Same goal
Different format
Know the
difference!"

Basis	Curriculum Vitae (CV)	Resume
Full Form	Curriculum Vitae (Latin for "course of life")	Resume (French word meaning "summary")
Length	Longer (2 or more pages)	Shorter (1-2 pages)
Purpose	Provides a complete overview of your academic and professional life.	Provides a brief and targeted summary of your skills and experience.
Content	Detailed information including education, work experience, research, publications, projects, certifications, etc.	Only relevant and most important information related to the job.
Focus	Comprehensive, covers entire career history.	Focused, customized for a specific job.
Usage	Used mainly for academic, research, teaching or higher education positions.	Used mainly for job applications in corporate and private sectors.
Format	Can be multiple pages, detailed and chronological.	Usually 1-2 pages, concise and well-structured.
Customization	Generally not customized for each application.	Tailored for each job based on the requirements.
Level of Detail	Includes complete information, even older achievements.	Includes only recent and relevant information.
Common Sections	Personal details, education, work experience, research, publications, projects, skills, awards, references, etc.	Personal details, summary or objective, education, work experience, skills, achievements, etc.
Used In	Academia, research institutions, NGOs, higher studies (MS/PhD), government jobs (sometimes).	Private companies, startups, internships and most job applications.



Key Takeaways :

1. CV is detailed; Resume is concise.
2. CV is used for academic and research roles; Resume is used for most job applications.
3. CV covers your complete career; Resume highlights only relevant information.
4. Always choose the document according to the purpose and job requirements.

Unit - 5 : Interview

5.1 Interview Techniques & Interview Preparation

Meaning of Interview

An interview is a formal and purposeful conversation between an interviewer and a candidate to assess the candidate's knowledge, skills, personality, attitude and suitability for a particular job or opportunity. It is not just a question-answer session, but a two-way communication process. The interviewer learns about you, and you also get a chance to know more about the organization and the job role.



"An interview is an opportunity to show who you are, not just what you know."

Importance of Interview Techniques

- Helps in creating a positive first impression.
- Builds confidence and reduces nervousness.
- Helps in presenting your thoughts in a clear and organized way.
- Shows your communication and interpersonal skills.
- Increases the chances of selection.
- Helps you handle difficult questions and real-life situations.
- Demonstrates your problem-solving and decision-making abilities.

Key Points to Remember :

- Be punctual
- Dress appropriately
- Be confident and polite
- Maintain good body language
- Listen carefully
- Answer honestly
- Show interest in the organization
- Ask relevant questions

Preparing for an Interview

1. Research about the Organization - Know about the company's mission, vision, products/services, recent news and work culture.
2. Understand the Job Role - Read the job description carefully and match your skills with the requirements.
3. Prepare Your Documents - Keep your updated resume, educational certificates, identity proof and other relevant documents ready.
4. Practice Common Questions - Prepare answers for commonly asked questions like "Tell me about yourself", "Why should we hire you?" etc.
5. Improve Communication Skills - Speak clearly, use correct language and avoid filler words like "um" or "you know".
6. Work on Your Body Language - Maintain eye contact, sit properly, smile and show confidence.
7. Be Mentally Prepared - Stay calm, positive and be yourself.
8. Plan Your Journey - Know the interview venue, time and route in advance to avoid last-minute problems.

Do's and Don'ts

Do's ✓

- Be honest
- Show enthusiasm
- Use positive language
- Listen carefully
- Ask questions
- Thank the interviewer

Don'ts ✗

- Don't be late
- Don't give false information
- Don't speak negatively about previous employers
- Don't interrupt
- Don't use mobile phone
- Don't be overconfident

Conclusion

Proper interview techniques and preparation can make a big difference in your success. With the right attitude, good communication and thorough preparation, you can face the interview with confidence and perform well.



Golden Tips :

- ★ Know yourself
- ★ Stay updated
- ★ Be confident
- ★ Learn from every interview
- ★ Turn every interview into a learning experience

5.2 Interview Formats

An interview can be conducted in different formats depending on the purpose, profile, number of candidates and the organization's hiring process. Each format has its own features, advantages and is suitable for specific situations. Knowing the different interview formats helps you understand what to expect and prepare accordingly.

1. **One-to-One Interview** : A single interviewer conducts the interview. It allows for in-depth discussion and is the most common format.
2. **Panel Interview** : A group of interviewers (usually 2 or more) ask questions. It is used for senior positions and provides multiple perspectives.
3. **Group Interview** : Multiple candidates are interviewed together. It helps the employer assess communication, leadership and teamwork skills.
4. **Telephonic Interview** : Conducted over a phone call. It is usually the initial screening round to shortlist candidates.
5. **Video Interview** : Conducted through online platforms like Zoom, Google Meet, etc. It is widely used for remote hiring.
6. **Stress Interview** : The interviewer deliberately creates a stressful environment to test the candidate's patience and response.

Common Interview Formats (Visual View)



One-to-One



Panel



Group



Telephonic



Video



Stress

"Different formats, but the same goal – to find the right talent."

5.3 Types of Interview Questions

In an interview, different types of questions are asked to assess a candidate's knowledge, skills, attitude, experience and overall suitability for the job. Being aware of these types helps you prepare better and answer confidently.

1. **General Questions** : These are basic questions about you, such as "Tell me about yourself" or "Why do you want to work here?".
2. **Behavioral Questions** : These questions assess your past experiences and behavior. Example – "Can you describe a time when you faced a challenge and how you handled it?".
3. **Technical Questions** : These are job-specific questions to test your subject knowledge and practical skills.
4. **Situational Questions** : These questions present a hypothetical situation to see how you would react. Example – "What would you do if...?".
5. **Case Study Questions** : Mostly used in management and analytical roles. You are given a problem or case and asked to find a solution.
6. **HR Questions** : These questions focus on your personality, strengths, weaknesses, career goals and cultural fit.
7. **Brain Teaser Questions** : These are logical or tricky questions to check your problem-solving ability.
8. **Closing Questions** : At the end, you may be asked if you have any questions for the interviewer.

Examples of Questions

- Tell me about yourself.
- What are your strengths and weaknesses?
- Why should we hire you?
- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- How do you handle pressure?
- Do you have any questions for us?

Tips to Answer Effectively

- ☒ Be honest and confident
- ☒ Give clear and structured answers
- ☒ Use real examples
- ☒ Stay positive
- ☒ Listen carefully to the question
- ☒ Avoid irrelevant information

"Prepare well, answer smartly, and make a lasting impression."

5.4 Mock Interviews

Meaning

A mock interview is a simulated interview session that helps you practice for a real job interview. It is usually conducted by a teacher, mentor, career counselor or a peer, who acts as an interviewer and asks questions similar to those asked in actual interviews. The main purpose of a mock interview is to give you a real interview experience in a safe and supportive environment so that you can identify your strengths and weaknesses and improve your performance before the final interview.

How Mock Interviews are Conducted?

1. The interviewer asks questions based on your resume, skills, experience and general knowledge.
2. The session may be conducted in person, online (video call) or in a group setting.
3. You are expected to answer the questions just like a real interview.
4. After the session, you receive feedback on your performance, including your strengths, areas for improvement and suggestions.
5. You can practice multiple times to gain confidence and improve your answers.

5.5 Benefits of Mock Interviews

1. **Builds Confidence** - Regular practice helps you feel more confident and reduces nervousness during the actual interview.
2. **Improves Communication Skills** - You learn to express your thoughts clearly and effectively.
3. **Helps Identify Weaknesses** - You get constructive feedback and can work on your weak areas.
4. **Familiarizes You with Interview Process** - You understand the interview environment, types of questions and time management.
5. **Enhances Problem-Solving Skills** - You learn to think quickly and give better answers in challenging situations.
6. **Increases Chances of Success** - With proper practice and preparation, you perform better in the real interview and improve your chances of selection.

Mock interviews turn nervousness into confidence and practice into success."



"Practice today for a better tomorrow!"



Common Mock Interview Questions

- Tell me about yourself.
- Why do you want to work in this field?
- What are your strengths and weaknesses?
- Where do you see yourself in 5 years?
- Why should we hire you?
- Can you describe a challenge you faced and how you handled it?
- Do you have any questions for us?

Tips for a Successful Mock Interview

- ✓ Prepare well before the session.
- ✓ Dress formally, just like a real interview.
- ✓ Be honest and natural in your answers.
- ✓ Listen carefully to the questions.
- ✓ Maintain good body language (eye contact, posture, smile).
- ✓ Take feedback positively and work on it.
- ✓ Practice regularly with different people.
- ✓ Try to answer within the given time.
- ✓ Ask for suggestions at the end.

